JAMES MAXWELL REID

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Edinburgh, United Kingdom

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Principal Engineer with seven years of IT experience, though my career has taken some unconventional turns that have given me exposure across multiple technical domains. Started as a Graduate Software Developer, then managed a team of 18 backend engineers as a Mid-Level Systems Analyst just two years in, before transitioning to Principal Engineer at my current role. I thrive in fast-paced environments where ambiguity is the norm and I can influence technical strategy at the highest levels. Based in Edinburgh but available for hybrid arrangements across the UK.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

Synapse Data Ltd

synapse-data.io

Remote

March 2022 - Present

Led architectural decisions for a distributed microservices platform serving 150+ enterprise clients across Europe and Asia-Pacific

Established coding standards and best practices framework that reduced production incidents by 34% within first year

Mentored five mid-level engineers and oversaw the successful delivery of three major platform upgrades worth GBP 2.3M combined revenue

Designed and implemented a real-time data processing pipeline handling 2.5 billion events daily using Apache Kafka and Elasticsearch

Senior Systems Analyst

Capgemini UK

capgemini.com

London, United Kingdom

September 2020 - February 2022

Managed infrastructure modernization for FTSE 100 financial services client, coordinating with teams of 18+ engineers across London and Bangalore

Implemented cloud migration strategy using AWS that reduced operational costs by 28% and improved system availability to 99.98%

Architected containerization approach using Docker and Kubernetes, enabling deployment frequency to increase from monthly to daily releases

Directed department-wide digital transformation initiative involving 50 stakeholders and three external consulting partners

Graduate Software Developer

IBM United Kingdom

ibm.com

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

June 2017 - August 2020

Developed microservices components in Java and Python for internal customer engagement platform used by 200+ enterprise accounts

Contributed to open standards compliance work and maintained legacy systems supporting critical banking operations across eight UK branches

Collaborated with product managers and UX designers to deliver features used by over 500,000 end users

Participated in agile ceremonies and contributed to sprint planning, retrospectives, and technical design reviews

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Edinburgh

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

2013 - 2017

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, Go, TypeScript, SQL, Bash

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Azure, Google Cloud Platform

Containerization: Docker, Kubernetes, OpenShift

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, Redis

Message Queues: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS

DevOps Tools: Jenkins, GitLab CI/CD, Terraform, Ansible

Monitoring: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, New Relic

Architecture: Microservices, Event-Driven Systems, Distributed Systems

Methodologies: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, Infrastructure as Code